A Cheatsheet for World Models

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A Graph Laplacian and Spectral Clustering

A.1 Preliminaries

Given a set of data points $x_1,\ldots,x_n$ and some notion of similarity $s_{ij} \geq 0$ between all pairs of data points x_i, x_j, the weighted adjacency matrix is $W = (w_{ij})$ where $w_{ij} = s_{ij}$. Form the similarity graph $G = (V,E)$, where $\begin{cases} v_i & \text{a data point } x_i \\ e_{ij} & \begin{cases} 1 & s_{ij} \geq t \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \end{cases}$ where t is a certain threshold. Then the problem of clustering can be reformulated to the problem of partitioning graph s.t. the edges between different groups have very low weights and the edges within a group have high weights. Assume G is undirected, i.e. $W = W^T$, $\forall i,j,\ w_{ij} = w_{ji}$. The degree of a vertex $v_i \in V$ is defined as $d_i = \sum_{j=1}^{n} w_{ij}$. The degree matrix D is defined as the diagonal matrix with degrees $d_1,\ldots,d_n$ on the diagonal. Given a subset of vertices $A \subset V$, $\bar{A} \equiv V \setminus A$. Define the indicator vector $\mathbb{1}_A = (f_1,\ldots,f_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n$ as the vector with $f_i = \begin{cases} 1 & v_i \in A \\ 0 & v_i \in \bar{A} \end{cases}$. Also define the size of a subset $A \subset V$, as the number of vertices in A, denoted $|A|$ and $\text{vol}(A) \equiv \sum_{i \in A} d_i$. A subset A is called a connected component if it is connected

and if there are no connections between vertices in A and $\bar{A}$. For two not necessarily disjoint sets $A, B \subset V$, $W(A,B) \equiv \sum_{i \in A, j \in B} w_{ij}$. The nonempty sets $A_1, \ldots, A_k$ form a partition of the graph if $\begin{cases} A_i \cap A_j = \emptyset \\ A_1 \cup \cdots \cup A_k = V \end{cases}$.

There are several ways to transform a given set $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ of data points with pairwise similarities s_{ij} into a graph. The most widely used ones include the ϵ-neighbourhood graph, k-nearest neighbour graph, and the fully connected graph.

A.2 Un-normalised Case

The unnormalised graph Laplacian matrix is defined as $L = D - W$.

Proposition A.1. *The matrix L satisfies the following properties:*

1. $\forall f \in \mathbb{R}^n,\ f^T L f = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i,j=1}^n w_{ij} (f_i - f_j)^2$
2. *L is symmetric and p.s.d.*
3. *The smallest eigenvalue of L is 0, the corresponding eigenvector is the constant one vector* $\mathbb{1}$.
4. *L has n non-negative real-valued eigenvalues* $0 = \lambda_1 \leq \lambda_2 \leq \cdots \leq \lambda_n$

pf.

- $$\begin{aligned} f^T L f &= f^T D f - f^T W f && \text{by the definition of } L \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n d_i f_i^2 - \sum_{i,j=1}^n f_i f_j w_{ij} && \text{by the definition of } d_i \\ &= \frac{1}{2} (\sum_{i=1}^n d_i f_i^2 - 2 \sum_{i,j} f_i f_j w_{ij} + \sum_{j=1}^n d_j f_j^2) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i,j} w_{ij} (f_i - f_j)^2 \end{aligned}$$.
- The symmetry of L follows directly from the symmetry of W, D. The p.s.d. is direct consequence of the first stmt, which shows $f^T L f \geq 0,\ \forall f \in \mathbb{R}^n$
- $L\mathbb{1} = D\mathbb{1} - W\mathbb{1} = (d_i - \sum_{j=1}^n w_{ij})_{i=1,\ldots,n} = 0$ by the definition of d_i, i.e. $\mathbb{1}$ is an eigenvector of L with eigenvalue 0. Since L is p.s.d., all its eigenvalues are non-negative. Thus the smallest eigenvalue of L is 0, with eigenvector $\mathbb{1}$.
- direct consequences of the previous stmts.

Proposition A.2. *Let G be an undirected graph with non-negative weights. Then the multiplicity k of the eigenvalue 0 of L equals the number of connected components* $A_1, \ldots, A_k$ *in the graph. The eigenspace of eigenvalue 0 is spanned by the indicator vectors* $\mathbb{1}_{A_1}, \ldots, \mathbb{1}_{A_k}$ *of those components.*

pf.

- $k = 1$

  the graph is connected. Assume f is an eigenvector with eigenvalue 0. Then $0 = f^T L f = \sum_{ij} w_{ij}(f_i - f_j)^2$ where $w_{ij} \geq 0$, $\forall i, j$. Then it is only possible when $w_{ij}(f_i - f_j)^2$ vanish. Thus if two vertices v_i, v_j are connected, $f_i = f_j$. With this argument, f needs to be constant for all vertices which can be connected by a path in the graph. Additionally, as all vertices of a connected component in an undirected graph can be connected by a path, f needs to be constant on the whole connected component. Since we have only 1 component, we only have the constant one vector $\mathbb{1}$ as eigenvector with eigenvalue 0.

- $k \geq 2$

  Wlog, assume that the vertices are ordered according to the connected components they belong to. Then the adjacency matrix W has a block diagonal form and the same is true for the matrix L. Then each of the blocks L_i is a proper graph Laplacian on its own, namely the Laplacian corresponding to the subgraph of the ith connected component. As it is the case for all block diagonal matrices, the spectrum of L is given by the union of the spectra of L_i and the corresponding eigenvectors of L are the eigenvectors of L_i, filled with 0 at the positions of the other blocks. As each L_i is a graph Laplacian of a connected graph, we know each L_i has eigenvalue 0 with multiplicity 1, and the corresponding eigenvector is the constant one vector on the ith connected component. Thus the matrix L has as many eigenvalues 0 as there are connected components and the corresponding eigenvectors are the indicator vectors of the connected components.

We measure the pairwise similarities $s_{ij} = s(x_i, x_j)$ by some similarity function which is symmetric and non-negative and denote the corresponding similarity matrix by $S = (s_{ij})$. → The key trick used here is changing the representation of the abstract data points x_i to points $y_i \in \mathbb{R}^k$. This is possible due to the properties of the graph Laplacian.

A.3 Spectral Clustering as Graph Cut

The intuition of clustering is to separate points in different groups according to their similarities. For data given in the form of a similarity graph, it can be restated as to find a partition of the graph s.t. the edges between different groups have a very low weight and the edges within a group have high weight.

Algorithm 1 Unnormalised Spectral Clustering

Require: Similarity matrix $S \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$, the number k of clusters to construct.
Ensure: Clusters $A_1, \ldots, A_k$ with $A_i = \{j \mid y_j \in C_i\}$

1: Construct a similarity graph by one of the ways described in Preliminaries. Let W be its weighted adjacency matrix.
2: Compute the unnormalised Laplacian L.
3: Compute the first k eigenvectors $u_1, \ldots, u_k$ of L.
4: Let $U \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times k}$ be the matrix containing the vectors $u_1, \ldots, u_k$ as columns.
5: **for** $i = 1, \ldots, n$ **do**
6: Let $y_i \in \mathbb{R}^k$ be the vector corresponding to the ith row of U.
7: **end for**
8: Cluster the points $(y_i)_{i=1,\ldots,n}$ in $\mathbb{R}^k$ with the k-means algorithm into clusters $C_1, \ldots, C_k$.

e.g. Mincut Problem
For a given number k of subsets, the mincut approach consists in choosing a partition $A_1, \ldots, A_k$ which minimises $\text{cut}(A_1, \ldots, A_k) \equiv \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^{k} W(A_i, \bar{A}_i)$.
→ when $k = 2$, it can be solved efficiently, but for $k > 2$, in many cases, the solution of mincut simply separates one individual vertex from the rest of the graph.

One solution for the above problem is forcing the sets $A_1, \ldots, A_k$ reasonably large.

- RatioCut

  The size of a subset A of a graph is measured by $|A|$ and the objective function becomes $\text{RatioCut}(A_1, \ldots, A_k) \equiv \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^{k} \frac{W(A_i, \bar{A}_i)}{|A_i|} = \sum \frac{\text{cut}(A_i, \bar{A}_i)}{|A_i|}$ where $|A_1| = \cdots = |A_k|$ the quantity's minimum is attained.

  - $k = 2$

    $$\min_{A \subset V} \text{RatioCut}(A, \bar{A}), \text{where } A \text{ is a proper subset of } V$$

    Given a nonempty subset $A \subset V$, define the vector $f = (f_1, \ldots, f_n)^T \in \mathbb{R}^n$ where $f_i = \begin{cases} \sqrt{|\bar{A}|/|A|} & v_i \in A \\ -\sqrt{|A|/|\bar{A}|} & v_i \in \bar{A} \end{cases}$. Then the objective function can be rewritten using the unnormalised graph Laplacian

$$f^T L f = \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{ij} w_{ij}(f_i - f_j)^2$$

$$= \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{i\in A, j\in \bar{A}} w_{ij}\left(\sqrt{\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|}} + \sqrt{\tfrac{|A|}{|\bar{A}|}}\right)^2 + \tfrac{1}{2}\sum_{i\in \bar{A}, j\in A} w_{ij}\left(-\sqrt{\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|}} - \sqrt{\tfrac{|A|}{|\bar{A}|}}\right)^2 \quad \text{by the definition of}$$

$$= \mathrm{cut}(A,\bar{A})\left(\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|} + \tfrac{|A|}{|\bar{A}|} + 2\right) \quad \text{by the definition of cut } W(A,\bar{A}) = W(\bar{A},A)$$

$$= \mathrm{cut}(A,\bar{A})\left(\tfrac{|A|+|\bar{A}|}{|A|} + \tfrac{|A|+|\bar{A}|}{|\bar{A}|}\right) = |V|\mathrm{RatioCut}(A,\bar{A})$$

Additionally $\sum_i f_i = \sum_{i\in A}\sqrt{\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|}} - \sum_{i\in\bar{A}}\sqrt{\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|}} = |A|\sqrt{\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|}} - |\bar{A}|\sqrt{\tfrac{|A|}{|\bar{A}|}} = 0$, i.e. the vector f is orthogonal to the constant one vector. Also $||f||^2 = \sum_i f_i^2 = |A|\tfrac{|\bar{A}|}{|A|} + |\bar{A}|\tfrac{|A|}{|\bar{A}|} = |\bar{A}| + |A| = n$. Thus the problem can be rewritten as

$$\min_{A\subset V} f^T L f \text{ s.t. } \begin{cases} f \perp \mathbb{1} \\ ||f|| = \sqrt{n} \end{cases}, \text{ where } f_i = \begin{cases} \sqrt{|\bar{A}|/|A|} & v_i \in A \\ -\sqrt{|A|/|\bar{A}|} & v_i \in \bar{A} \end{cases}$$

This is a discrete optimisation problem as the entries of the solution vector f are only allowed to take two particular values and it is NP-hard. So by discarding the discreteness condition, we can get the relaxed optimisation problem

$$\min_{f\in\mathbb{R}^n} f^T L f \text{ s.t. } \begin{cases} f \perp \mathbb{1} \\ ||f|| = \sqrt{n} \end{cases}$$

Then by the Rayleigh–Ritz theorem, the solution of this problem is given by the vector f which is the eigenvector corresponding to the second smallest eigenvalue of L, given that the smallest eigenvalue of L is 0 with eigenvector $\mathbb{1}$. Then we re-transform the real-valued solution vector f of the relaxed problem into a discrete indicator vector. The simplest way is to use the sign of f as indicator function, i.e. $\begin{cases} v_i \in A & f_i \geq 0 \\ v_i \in \bar{A} & f_i < 0 \end{cases}$. But this heuristic is too simple, and most spectral clustering algorithms use $\begin{cases} v_i \in A & f_i \in C \\ v_i \in \bar{A} & f_i \in \bar{C} \end{cases}$ where $C, \bar{C}$ are groups clustering f_i in $\mathbb{R}$.

- arbitrary k

Given a partition of V into k sets $A_1,\ldots,A_k$, we define k indicator vectors $h_j = (h_{1j},\ldots,h_{nj})^T$ where $h_{ij} = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\sqrt{|A_j|}} & v_i \in A_j \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$. Then define the matrix $H \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times k}$ as the matrix containing those k indicator vectors as columns. Then the columns of H are orthonormal, i.e. $H^T H = I$.

Also $h_i^T L h_i = \frac{\text{cut}(A_i, \bar{A}_i)}{|A_i|} = (H^T L H)_{ii}$. This implies $\text{RatioCut}(A_1, \ldots, A_k) = \sum_{i=1}^k h_i^T L h_i = \sum (H^T L H)_{ii} = \text{Tr}(H^T L H)$. So the problem becomes

$$\min_{A_1,\ldots,A_k} \text{Tr}(H^T L H) \text{ s.t. } H^T H = I, \text{ where } h_{ij} = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\sqrt{|A_j|}} & v_i \in A_j \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Then we can relax this problem by allowing the entries of the matrix H to take arbitrary real values, and get

$$\min_{H \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times k}} \text{Tr}(H^T L H) \text{ s.t. } H^T H = I$$

By the Rayleigh–Ritz theorem, the solution is given by choosing H as the matrix which contains the first k eigenvectors of L as columns. Here the matrix H is in fact the matrix U used in the unnormalised spectral clustering algorithm. Then we can re-convert the real-valued solution matrix to a discrete partition as previously.

- NCUT

  The size of a subset A is measured by the $\text{vol}(A)$ and the objective function becomes $\text{NCut}(A_1, \ldots, A_k) \equiv \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^k \frac{W(A_i, \bar{A}_i)}{\text{vol}(A_i)} = \sum \frac{\text{cut}(A_i, \bar{A}_i)}{\text{vol}(A_i)}$ where $\text{vol}(A_1) = \cdots = \text{vol}(A_k)$ the quantity's minimum is attained.